

Herb Gardening for Seniors

- Planning Sheets

From *Herb Gardening for Seniors* by Helen Marchbank (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The Sowing and Planting Calendar

For a temperate climate (last frost mid-April, first frost mid-October). S = sow, P = plant a bought plant, C = take cuttings, D = divide, H = harvest.

Herb	Jan-Feb	Mar-Apr	May-Jun	Jul-Aug	Sep-Oct	Nov-Dec
Parsley	S (sill)	S, P	H	H; S for winter	H	H (sill)
Chives		D, P	H, cut back	H	D	
Mint		D, P	H, C	H, cut down	H	
Thyme		P	H, C	H, trim	H	H (light)
Rosemary		P	H, C, trim	H, C	H	H (light)
Basil		S (sill)	S, P out late May	S, H, pinch	H, pesto	
Oregano		D, P	H	H, cut back, dry	H	
Marjoram		S (sill)	P out	H	C, bring in	
Sage		P	H, C, trim	H, C	H	H (light)
Bay		P, top-dress	H	H, clip	H, in if cold	H
Tarragon		D, P	H	H, cut back	in if wet	

Lavender		P	C	H flowers, trim		
Coriander	S (sill)	S	S	S (shade)	S (sill)	
Dill		S	S	S	H seed	
Chervil	S (sill)	S		S	S	H (sill)
Fennel		S, P	H	H	H seed	
Sorrel		S, D, P	H	H	H	
Lemon balm		D, P	H, C	H, cut back, dry		
Lemon verbena		P	H, C	H, dry	in by Oct	dormant
Chamomile		S	H flowers	H flowers, dry		
Borage		S	H flowers	H flowers		
Nasturtium		S	H	H	H seed	
Garlic chives		D, P	H	H, flowers	D	
Lovage		D, P	H, cut back	H	H	
Peppermint		D, P	H, C	H, cut down, dry	H	
Lemongras s	root a stalk		P out	H	in by Oct	
Winter savory		P	H, C	H, trim	H	H (light)

Stevia			P out late May	H, pinch	H, dry, in	
Salad burnet	H	S, D, P	H	H	H	H
Vietnamese coriander	H (sill)	C	P out	H	in by Oct	H (sill)

The Pot-Size, Light and Water Chart

Herb	Kind	Light	Water	Pot (cm)	Winter
Parsley	Biennial as annual	Sun or part shade	Moist	20	Cloche outside, or the sill
Chives	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	15-20	Dies back; returns
Mint	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	20-30, own pot	Dies back; returns
Thyme	Hardy evergreen	Full sun	Dry	15-20, gritty	Outside on feet
Rosemary	Hardy evergreen	Full sun	Dry	25-40, gritty	Outside, wall, feet
Basil	Tender annual	Full sun	Moist, mornings	12-20	Dies; resow
Oregano	Hardy perennial	Full sun	Dry to moderate	20, gritty	Dies back; returns
Marjoram	Half-hardy	Full sun	Moderate	15-20	Cuttings indoors
Sage	Hardy evergreen	Full sun	Dry	25, gritty	Outside on feet
Bay	Evergreen tree	Sun or light shade	Moderate	30-50, loam	Porch if below -5
Tarragon	Half-hardy	Full sun	Moderate	20-25, gritty	Under cover if wet
Lavender	Hardy evergreen	Full sun	Dry	25-30, gritty	Outside on feet
Coriander	Annual	Sun; shade	Moist	15-20, deep	Sill only

From Herb Gardening for Seniors by Helen Marchbank (Oro Enigma Publishing). Free for personal use. oroenigma.com/herbs

		in summe r			
Dill	Annual	Full sun	Moist	20, deep	No
Chervil	Hardy annual	Part shade	Moist	15-20	Cloche or sill
Fennel	Hardy perennial	Full sun	Moderate	30-40, deep	Dies back; returns
Sorrel	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	20-25	Dies back; returns
Lemon balm	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moderate	20-25	Dies back; returns
Lemon verbena	Tender shrub	Full sun	Moderate; dry in winter	25-30	Indoors, dormant
Chamomile	Hardy annual	Full sun	Moderate	20	Self-seeds
Borage	Hardy annual	Full sun	Moderate	25, deep	Self-seeds
Nasturtium	Half-hardy annual	Full sun	Moderate	20	Self-seeds
Garlic chives	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	15-20	Dies back; returns
Lovage	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	40, deep	Dies back; returns
Peppermint	Hardy perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	20-30, own pot	Dies back; returns
Lemongras s	Tender perennial	Full sun, heat	Moist; drier in winter	30	Indoors
Winter savory	Hardy evergreen	Full sun	Dry	15-20, gritty	Outside on feet

Stevia	Tender perennial	Full sun	Moist	20	Indoors or cuttings
Salad burnet	Hardy evergreen	Sun or part shade	Moderate	15-20	Outside; picks all winter
Vietnamese coriander	Tender perennial	Sun or part shade	Moist	20	Indoors

My Herb Garden

Where (sill, balcony, door, bed)	Sun (hours, and when)	Pots I have	Herbs to grow

The Sowing and Buying Plan

Herb	Seed or plant	Sow or plant when	Where	Done

The Watering Log

The finger test first: dry a knuckle down for the Mediterranean herbs, just moist for the leafy ones. A tick when watered.

Pot	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun

The Harvest and Keeping Log

Herb	Picked (date)	How much	Dried, frozen, used	Notes

My Cautions

Every herb in the book is safe in the kitchen; this sheet is for anything the pharmacist said about daily teas or large amounts with a medicine.

Medicine	Herb to keep steady or avoid in quantity	What was said